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7-Eleven in Thailand

Macro Environmental
Factors Analyses

MKTG 466 - Global Marketing
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I. Introduction



7-Eleven

Brand Overview:

- 7-Eleven – global convenience store chain, originally from the U.S., now owned by Seven & i Holdings (Japan).

Scale:

- Over 83,000 stores in 19 countries and regions – one of the most successful global retail franchises.

Key Markets:

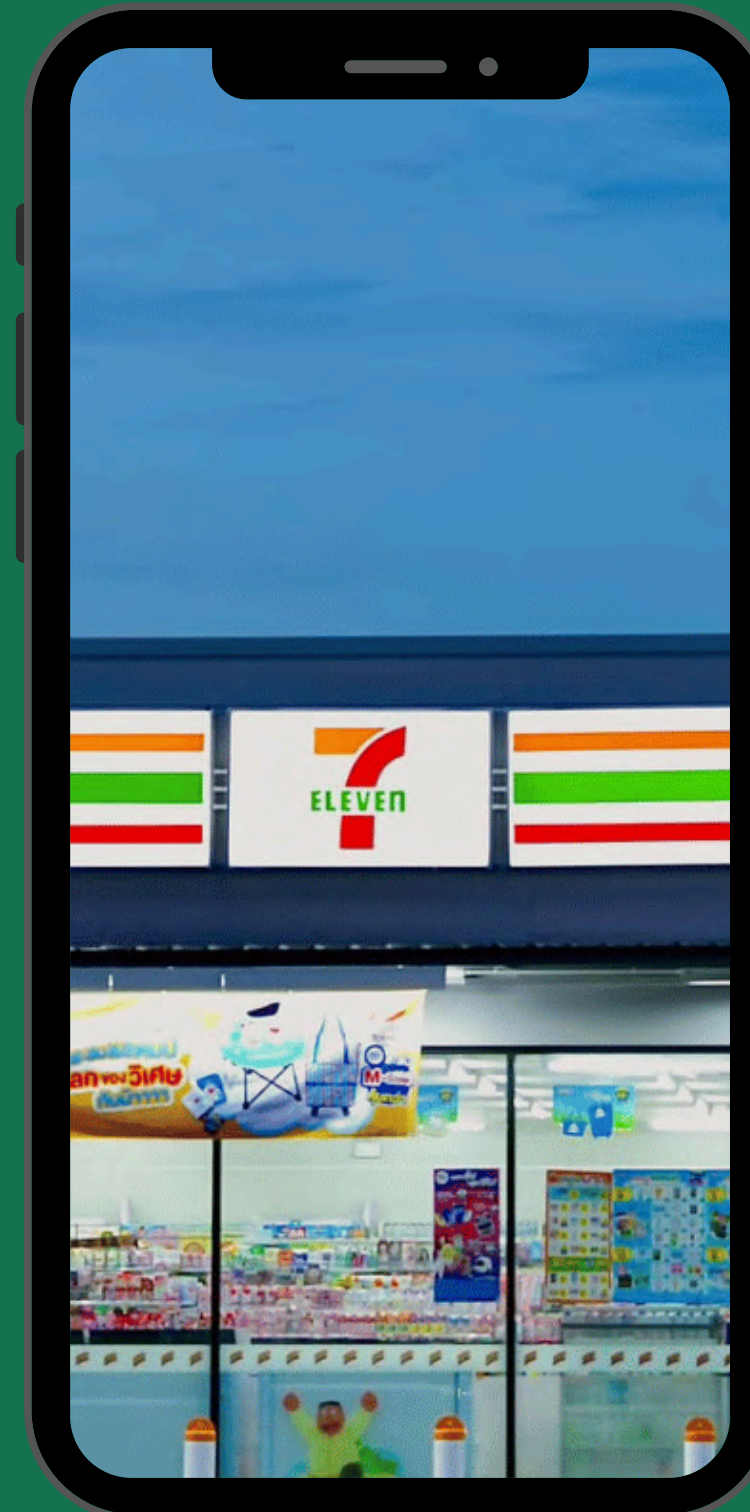
- Japan (largest), Thailand (second-largest number of branches).

Thailand Entry:

- Entered in 1989 via partnership with CP All Public Company Limited

Local Adaptation:

- Expanded rapidly by adapting to Thai consumer behaviors and preferences.



II. Macro-Environmental Analysis



ECONOMIC FACTORS

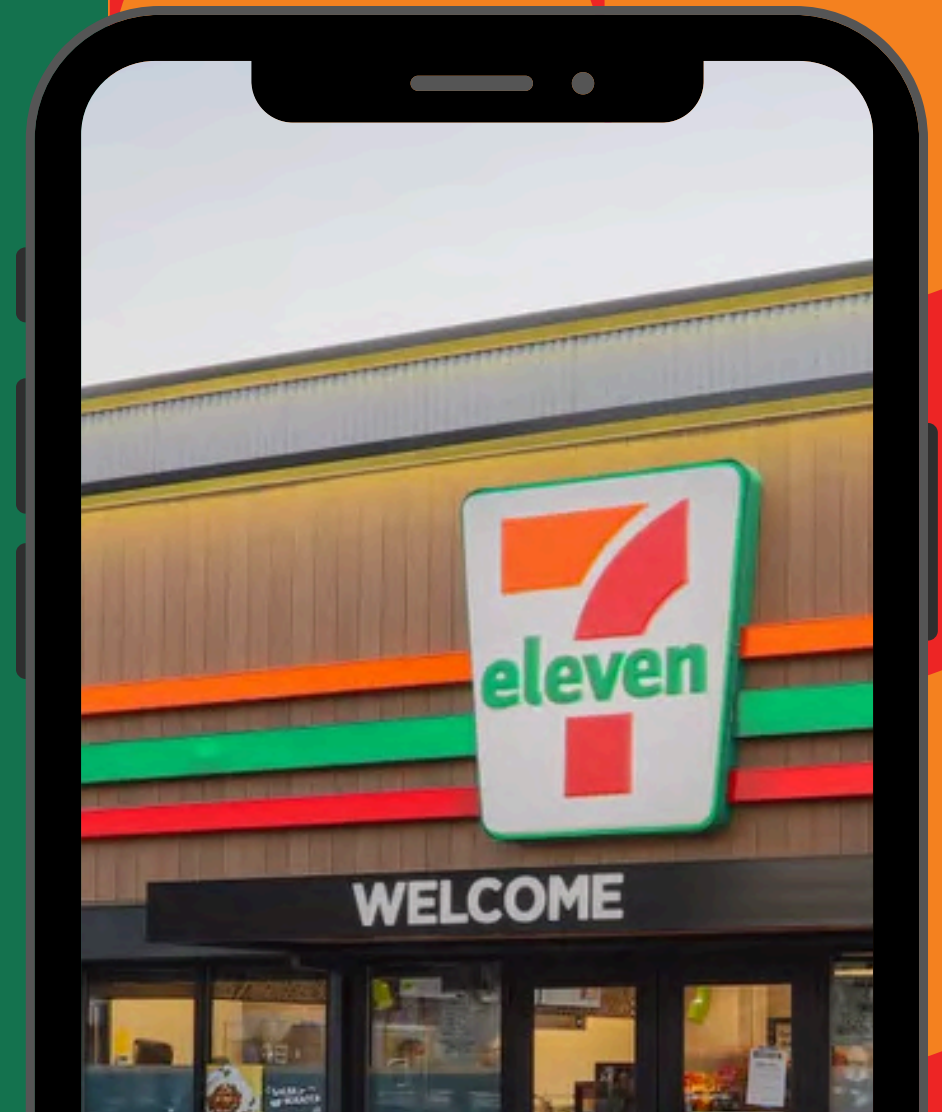
Economic Overview

- Upper-middle-income, export-oriented market economy.
- Liberal trade framework; strong private sector involvement.
- Well-developed infrastructure → supports retail & service growth. (Thailand - Market Overview, 2024)
- Attractive to foreign investment (e.g., 7-Eleven via CP All).



Performance

- GDP growth: **2.5% in 2024** (↑ from 2.0% in 2023). (World Bank, 2024)
- Growth drivers: Domestic consumption, tourism recovery.
- **High household debt:** 16.42 trillion baht (88.4% of GDP, Q4 2024). (Reuters, 2025)
- Debt among highest in Asia → constrains consumer spending.



7-Eleven Strategy

- **Low-income:** Budget foods, groceries, bundles.
- **Mid/high-income:** Premium snacks, drinks, services.
- Global network: **13,000+** stores; **+1,300 by 2030.** (ScrapeHero, 2025)



ECONOMIC FACTORS

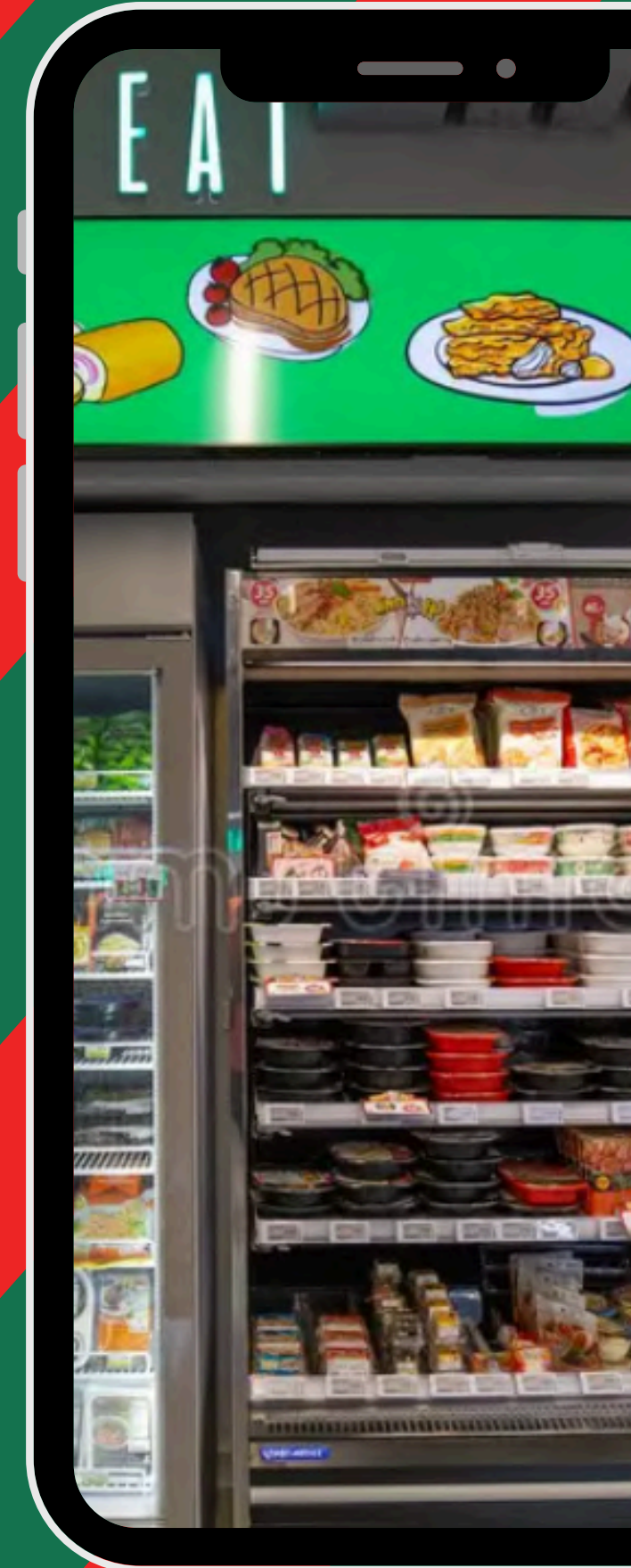
(World Bank Group, 2024)

✱ Opportunities

- Urbanization → higher demand for convenience goods.
- Rising middle class in urban areas.
- Govt. stimulus: Digital wallet scheme boosts low-income spending.

✱ Threats

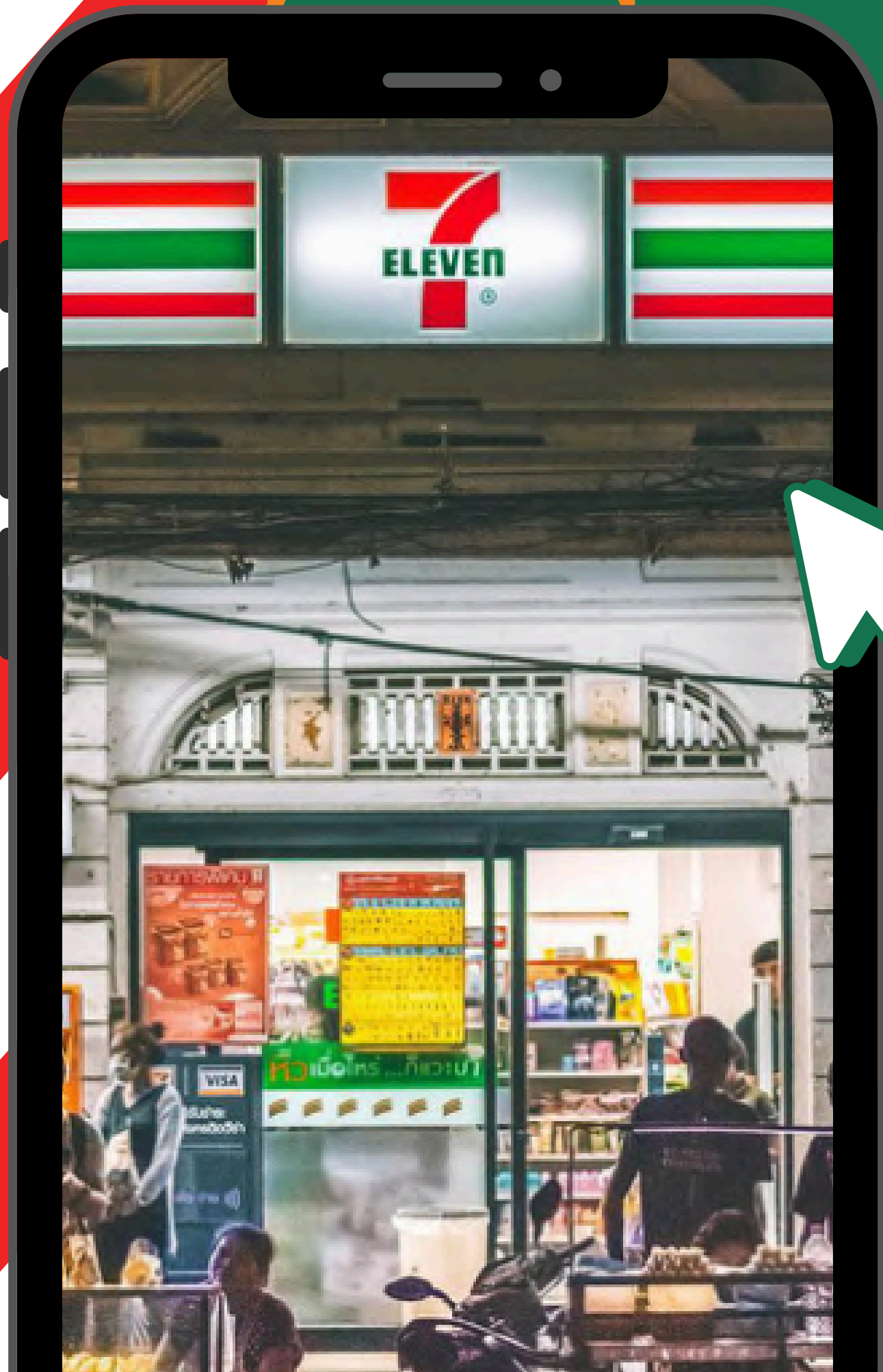
- Persistent income inequality.
- High debt → price sensitivity among consumers.
- Global economic volatility → risk to stable growth.



Cultural factor

Thailand – Hofstede's Cultural Dimensions.

- **High Power Distance (PDI 64)**
 - Society accepts hierarchy, respects authority.
 - Consumers trust well-established brands that communicate with politeness & prestige.
- **Low Individualism (IDV 20) – Collectivist culture**
 - Prioritizes relationships & harmony.
 - Community-oriented activities (e.g., family/friends stamp collecting).
 - Strong word-of-mouth sharing of campaigns.
- **Low Masculinity (MAS 34) – Feminine orientation**
 - Values cooperation & enjoyment over competition.
 - Lighthearted campaigns with friendly characters (e.g., Doraemon) work well.
- **High Uncertainty Avoidance (UAI 64)**
 - Preference for clarity & structure.
 - Expect transparent reward mechanics; trust drops if rules change.
- **Moderate Long-Term Orientation (LTO 56)**
 - Respects tradition but open to gradual innovation.
 - Long-running stamp campaigns gain strong, patient participation.



Impact of culture on branding and communication strategies



High-Context Communication

- Messages rely on symbolism, visuals, and emotional tone.
- Subtle, culturally resonant campaigns work better than direct sales pitches.

Hierarchy Acceptance

- Brands can take an “authority” role in setting campaign rules.
- Compliance is high if rules are transparent and fair.

Collectivism & Harmony

- Design activities for family & friends.
- Focus on communal enjoyment, not individual competition.

Feminine Orientation

- Playful, charming, and empathetic storytelling preferred.
- Avoid hard-sell or competitive messaging.

The 7-Eleven x Doraemon stamp campaign

- **Cultural Adaptation**

- Combines global pop culture (Doraemon) with Thai cultural elements (temples, khon masks, traditional foods).
- Nostalgic “cute” appeal evokes childhood memories & celebrates national heritage.

- **Collectivist Alignment**

- Families & groups collect stamps together.
- Shared joy in completing sets & redeeming rewards.

- **High Uncertainty Avoidance Fit**

- Clear structure & predictable benefits.
- Participation is stress-free & enjoyable.



Benefits and Risks of Cultural Localization

Benefits

- Fosters deep emotional bonds & enhances brand loyalty.
- Positions 7-Eleven as culturally respectful.
- Leverages nostalgia & sanuk (playfulness) to drive repeat purchases & positive word-of-mouth.



Risks

- **Cultural fatigue** – overusing motifs may reduce novelty.
- **Misrepresentation** – playful depictions of sacred symbols could spark backlash.
- **Over-localization** – may alienate international or cosmopolitan customers.
- **Delayed feedback** – indirect communication norms can mask consumer dissatisfaction.



SOCIAL FACTOR



Demographics & Role of Women in Purchasing

Balanced Market Base

With 71.7M people, a slight female majority, and median age of 40.1, Thailand provides a steady and varied customer pool for 7-Eleven.

Urban Consumer Reach

51.4% of the population lives in cities, giving the brand opportunities to serve both urban shoppers who want speed and rural customers with different buying habits (Population Information, 2025)

Women as Core Drivers

Urban working women, especially single professionals, buy more ready meals, cosmetics, and daily goods, directly shaping which products and promotions succeed.

Digital & Social Influence

Women's higher online research and shopping rates, plus their role as trendsetters on social media, make omnichannel selling and trend-responsive products essential.





Urbanization & Aspirational Consumers

- **Fast-Lane Lifestyles** : Over half the population in cities leads to greater demand for quick service, convenient store layouts, and extended hours. (Chi, 2018)
- **Youth-Centric Appeal**: Gen Z and Millennials value speed, technology, and products that fit their lifestyles, making them ideal for targeted campaigns.
- **Subculture-Driven Demand**: Groups like K-pop fans, fitness enthusiasts, and skincare followers influence product development and seasonal promotions.
- **Social-First Marketing**: Peer and celebrity recommendations on TikTok, Instagram, and LINE drive purchasing, so frequent product updates keep the brand relevant.

Social Risks & Crisis Response

In July 2025, tensions between Thailand and Cambodia escalated when a missile from Cambodian territory struck a 7-Eleven in Sisaket province. The attack killed eight civilians and destroyed the store. While such incidents are rare, it revealed the vulnerability of retail operations in politically unstable border regions (Chi, 2025).

Consumer Fear & Lower Foot Traffic

Safety concerns led shoppers in nearby areas to avoid stores, causing immediate sales drops and reduced engagement.

Brand Trust Damage

The association with an unsafe environment weakened public confidence, requiring visible reassurance measures.

Operational Risk Exposure

Locations in politically sensitive areas face higher risks to assets, staff, and customers, making store placement strategy critical.

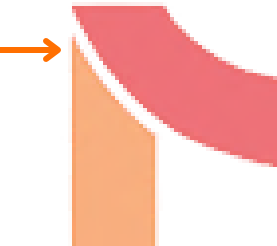
Need for Proactive Crisis Management

Transparent communication, enhanced safety protocols, and community outreach are essential to restore trust and maintain loyalty.

MASLOW'S HIERARCHY OF NEEDS



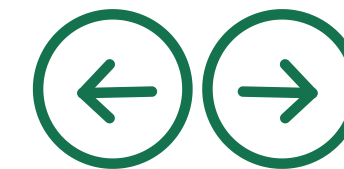
- **Physiological:** 24/7 access to food, drinks, and essentials for quick needs
- **Safety:** Clean, well-lit stores with safe payments and reliable products
- **Belongingness:** Loyalty programs and stamp campaigns; stores as neighborhood hubs
- **Esteem:** Member-only promotions, exclusive rewards, and premium imported products
- **Self-Actualization:** Diverse product options supporting lifestyle goals and personal expression



III. Brand Response & Adaptation



Market Performance & Growth Potential



In 2023

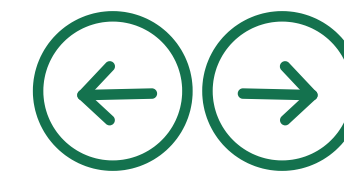
-  **15,403M baht** ^(Jan, 2024a)
Net profit (+35.1% YoY)
-  **68% market share** ^(Jan, 2024c)
in convenience store sector
-  **14,545 stores** ^(Jan, 2024a)
nationwide by end of 2023



Growth driven by:

- Rising consumer purchasing power (due to wage increases, gov policies)
- Return of international tourists





*Evolving Format to Meet New Demands

Shift from small shophouses
→ Big standalone stores with parking

EV charging stations at big-sized stores
(in partnership with EA)

Expanded services:

- All Cafe, Kudsan, Food Place (freshly brewed/baked/cooked)
- Health & wellness corners (Eat Well) in 1,500+ stores due to Thailand's entry into an aging society (Jan, 2022)
- eXta pharmacies with on-site pharmacists

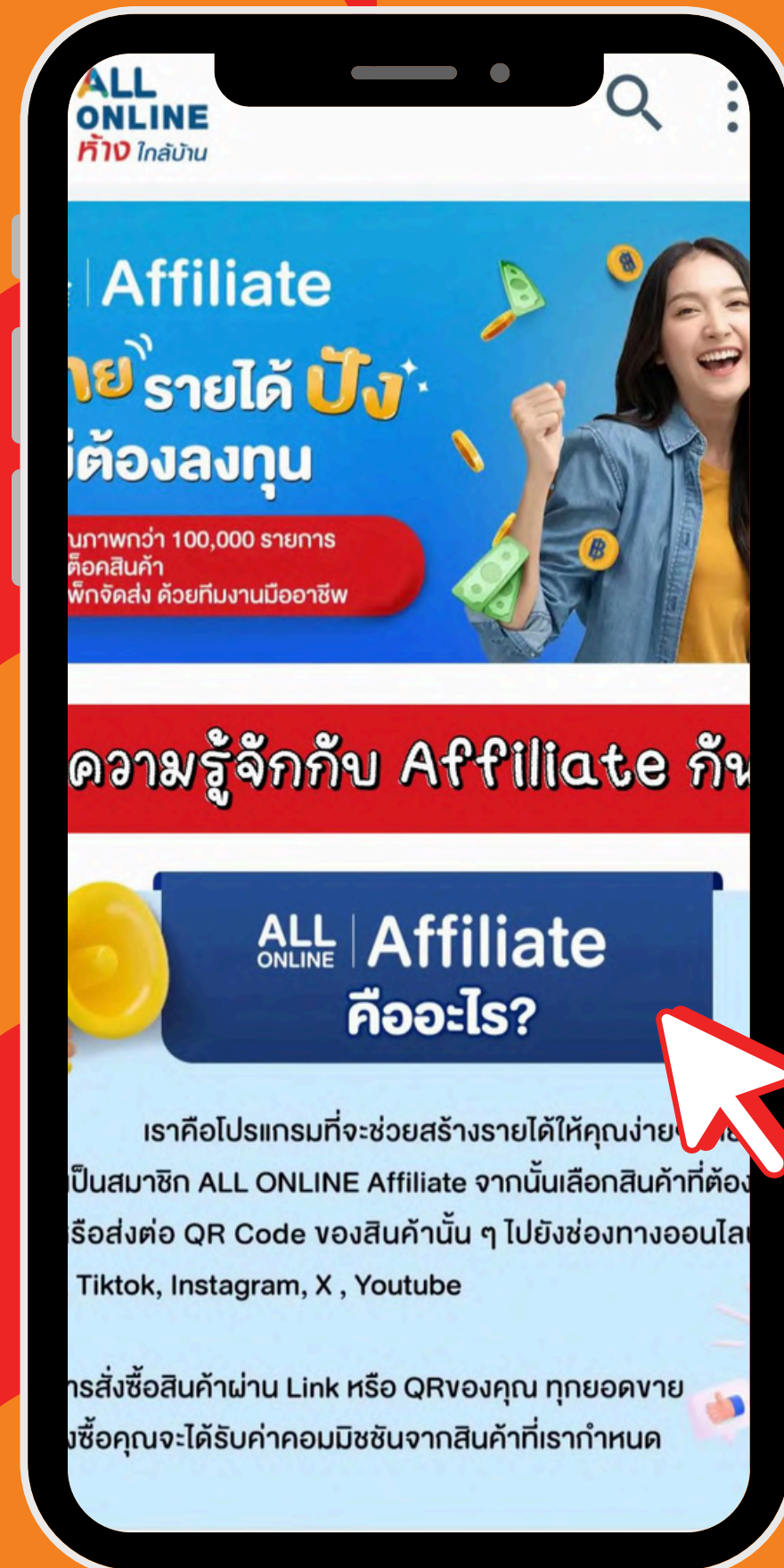
*Omnichannel & Affiliate Strategy

Delivery Expansion

“Stop by when you’re hungry”
→ **“Order** when you’re hungry”

*Responding to Thailand’s affiliate marketing boom post-COVID.

- *Launched an affiliate program allowing **anyone** to become a 7-Eleven online agent.
- Offers access to **100,000+ products**
 - Commission **up to 5%** (Jan, 2024c).



Product & Co-Branding

Localization + partnerships:

CPF cold cuts (Bucher Salami, Chorizo)

Uoriki sashimi restaurant in-store

MK Suki Sauce, DIY Dairy Queen

Customization & experiential retail



เตรียมเสิร์ฟ !

"Dairy Queen"

พร้อมทุก 7-11

เพิ่มอีก 10 สาขา !



Outperforming Competitors

- **2023 Revenue:** 920,841M baht, Profit: 18,482M baht
- F&B = 75.2% of revenue
- 1,216 SME suppliers, 9,763 products (incl. EZY Sweet Thai desserts)

(Jan, 2024a; Jan, 2024b; Marketeer, 2025; Buranthaveekoon, 2024a)



Recommendations



AI-powered dynamic pricing & Surplus marketplace

Insights

High shrinkage from perishables
Need for dynamic markdown automation



Recommendations

AI automark items nearing expiration to sell at dynamic pricing
Integrate “surprise surplus bag” feature for mobile app

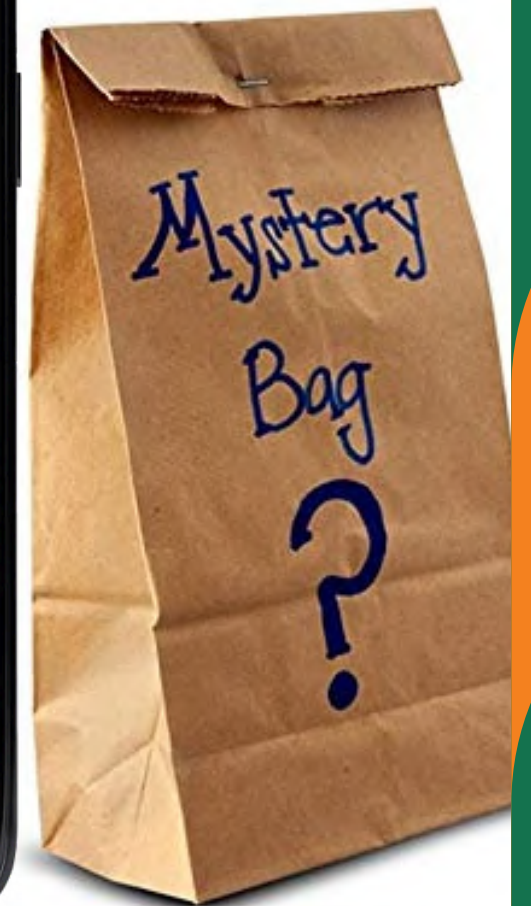
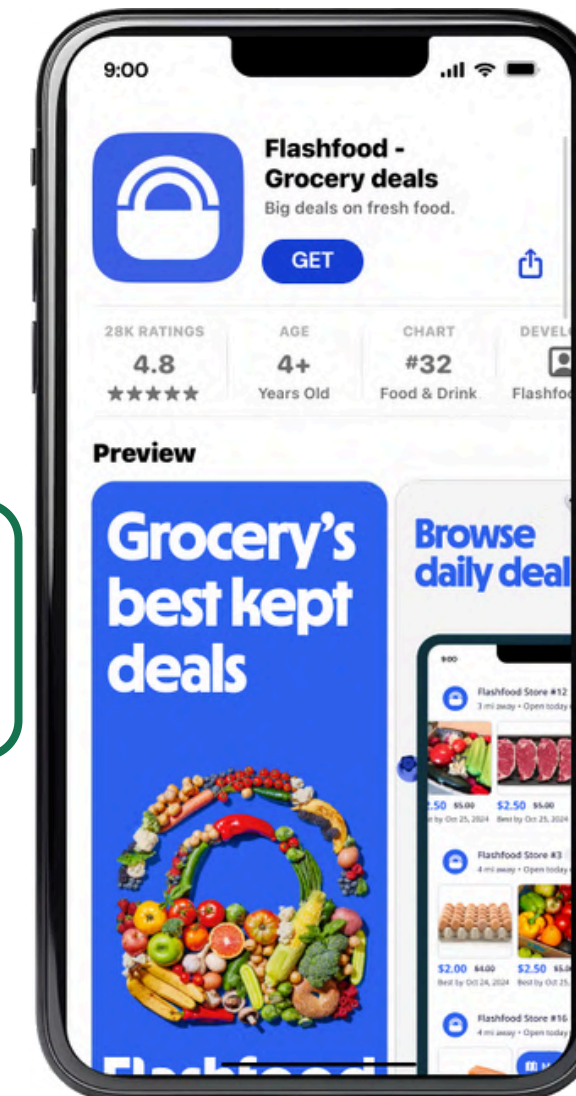


Planning

Pilot the system in 50 high-volume stores

Key metrics:

- sell rate of marked-down products
- reductions in food waste



“Smart pricing, less waste, more trust”

Recommendations

2

O2O Smart Locker Integration



“Order Online, Pick Anytime”

Insights

Urban consumers seek delivery flexibility



Recommendations

Deploy parcel lockers at storefront
Sync with app for click-and-collect flow

Implication:

- 1 30 pilot stores located near transport hubs, offices, or university campuses
- 2 Lockers integrated into the mobile application
- 3 APP: select pickup slots and receive automated notifications
- 4 Contactless authentication via QR codes

Recommendations

3 Deposit-Return & Refill Stations

Insights

Consumer demand for environmentally friendly retail solutions

Recommendation

- **Reusable-packaging bay**

- **Liquid refillery - home care/beauty**

(with FMCG partners)

Deposit taken

Refund

Bring

Refill

Scan

Earn points

KPIs

Return rate, cost per refill vs. single-use, plastic avoided, repeat rates.

Unilever scaled 900+ refill points in Indonesia



Carrefour x Loop ran deposit-based, reusable packs

Qyos and Alfamart in Indonesia: localized refill solutions



Recommendations



Safety Messaging in Brand Campaigns

Insights

Public safety perception affects retail behavior



Recommendations

Shift marketing tone to reinforce “safe, reliable, 24/7”
Collaborate with public agencies for calm narratives



Planning

Run billboard/app banners in Bangkok, Phuket
Feature customer & staff “safe space” stories





ขอบคุณครับ

THANKS FOR YOUR LISTENING

Now, we'd be happy to answer any questions you may have.



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